

Privacy Impact Assessment Guidance

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Use notice. This is an internally synthesized training document. Aurora Federation, Harbor State, Aster Legal, Matter Alpha, and every source cited here are fictional. It is not legal advice or a statement of current law.

Purpose

A structured assessment for new or materially changed processing that may affect individuals, employees, or regulated data.

Scope and boundary

A PIA documents accountable choices; it is not a blanket legal opinion or a substitute for security, procurement, or accessibility review.

Rule summary

A PIA identifies foreseeable effects before a high-risk processing change proceeds, assigns practical mitigations, and records who accepts any residual risk after the relevant specialists review the evidence.

Decision path

Step	Required action
1	Open the assessment Describe the processing, owner, purpose, population, locations, vendors, and change trigger.
2	Map risks Evaluate transparency, necessity, access, security, retention, transfers, automated effects, and rights handling.
3	Design mitigations Assign a named owner, due date, testable control, and residual-risk statement for each material risk.
4	Approve the outcome The accountable executive accepts residual risk only after Privacy Legal confirms the assessment is complete.

Operating controls

Escalation trigger

Escalate for large-scale monitoring, vulnerable populations, sensitive data, novel analytics, high-impact decisions, or a residual high risk.

Recordkeeping

Keep the signed PIA, data-flow map, risk register, control evidence, stakeholder reviews, approval, and annual or change-triggered refresh.

Roles and cadence

Business owner supplies complete facts and implements controls. Privacy Legal verifies the review path, decision rationale, and escalation. Records Management maintains retention evidence. Reassess on a material change, a new recipient or system, a control failure, or the scheduled annual review.

Fictional source register

Reference	Fictional use
Aurora Federation Privacy Framework, 2026 edition	Synthetic baseline for purpose limitation, accountability, and transfer review.
Harbor State Information Stewardship Rules, guidance note 4	Synthetic comparison point for notification, processor, and records controls.
Aster Legal Matter Alpha control register, 2026-06-30	Synthetic operational anchor for preservation target 42 and exception workflow.

Decision record minimum

Record the request or event, scope, facts relied upon, rule path, decision maker, conditions, escalation outcome, review date, and storage location. Do not include personal data, credentials, or privileged source material in this guidance record.